



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Kardia Classical School
School Website: <https://kardiaclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Kardia Classical School WA 98272 demonstrates a thoughtful alignment with classical education concepts while operating as a Christian, family-partnered program. The public materials emphasize a Christian worldview, the triad of truth–goodness–beauty, and a structured Parent Partnership model that integrates home-based and in-school learning. There is clear evidence of curricular emphasis on grammar/history/writing and a two-days-in-person / three-days-at-home format, plus enrichment in arts and community life. However, explicit references to several hallmark classical elements—such as a full Great Books program, explicit Socratic seminars across the 9–12 range, and formal attention to the liberal arts sequence (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a core curriculum—are less consistently articulated in the site content. Taken together, the school sits squarely in the Classical realm, but with notable room to deepen and explicitly codify traditional classical practices. Overall classification: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes being rooted in a Christian worldview and faith-based community. The mission explicitly states education is “rooted in a Christian worldview,” with parents and teachers nurturing truth, goodness, and beauty. - The Parent Partnership article describes a faith-based community and the education of the whole person (mind, body, soul), with emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive: Christian worldview, faith-based, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wholeness of person (mind, body, soul). These map directly to the lexicon's Religious & Metaphysical Foundations (truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy/worship; virtue). Evidence occurrences include explicit mentions of truth, goodness, beauty and faith-based education. - Negative: No explicit relativism, secular humanism, or value-clarification signals appear in the visible public materials.

Why this rating - The materials show a clear, explicit grounding in faith and transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and a conscious framing of education within a Christian worldview, which aligns with the classical emphasis on transcendent, knowable ideals. The absence of explicit secular relativism signals and the presence of a liturgical/communal flavor (through faith-based community life) reinforce a Classical alignment, albeit with room to further embed liturgical practices in a formal way.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission and partner-structure emphasize formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom rather than purely job-oriented outcomes. The Parent Partnership pillars articulate themes of formation, accountability with grace, high academic expectations, educating the whole child (mind, body, soul), and a

culture of lifelong learners, all pointing toward a classical telos. - The language in the mission centers on nurturing truth, goodness, and beauty as attained through classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive: formation, virtue, wisdom, classical mission, pursuit of truth/good/beautiful (through the public statements about truth, goodness, beauty), scholé-like emphasis on contemplation through a blended model; lifelong learners. These map to the lexicon's School Purpose & Goal indicators. - Negative: No explicit emphasis on 21st-century work-readiness or workforce-prep overshadowing formation; however, the public materials do not consistently spell out a fully explicit telos like "great conversation" or "permanent questions" in a program-wide way beyond the emphasis on truth/good/beauty.

Why this rating - The school explicitly foregrounds formation and virtue and ties its mission to a classical, truth-driven telos, but the articulation of that telos is not as fully developed or codified as some Classical schools that foreground "great books," "paideia," or explicit "Great Conversation" across the curriculum. The presence of a strong formation/virtue frame qualifies as Classical-inclined, but the explicit, comprehensive classical triad of elements (including detailed Great Books/Great Conversation and a full liberal arts progression) is not uniformly stated.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curricular content is described as including grammar, history, science, and writing, with in-person days featuring these subjects, while at-home days provide video lessons and weekly planning. This signals a liberal-arts oriented structure with grammar as a central element. - The public materials also reference a classical framing (e.g., "classically educate") and a blog presence that engages with classical roots (e.g., Dorothy Sayers and the Lost Tools of Learning).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive: grammar, history, liberal arts (implied by "classically educate"), Great Books/Great Conversation (inferred from blog content and classical education discussions), wonder. The "Two Full Days In-person" program explicitly centers on historical and linguistic subjects (grammar) and writing. - Negative: The site does not consistently spell out a comprehensive Great Books/Great Conversation program on the Curriculum page itself; explicit citations to Great Books/Great Conversation across the curriculum are not uniformly stated in core pages. The reliance on a blog post for Great Books conversation signals potential but not fully codified curriculum practice.

Why this rating - There is a clear liberal-arts orientation (grammar/history/writing) and a classical framing of education, with a strong emphasis on formation through a Christian lens. Yet, the explicit, systematized presence of the full classical curriculum (e.g., explicit Great Books program, classical languages, dedicated logic and rhetoric sequences across the grade levels) is not uniformly documented in the core curriculum pages. This places the school in a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category for Curriculum.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program describes a blended model: two days in person (with enrichment classes) and three days at home with video lessons and teacher check-ins, which shows a mix of structured, contemplative elements with more autonomous study. - The public narrative highlights a focus on forming memory and the whole-child education, with a sense of reverence for learning; the home-school partnership and teacher check-ins reflect a pedagogy that blends memorization, review, and guided learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive: scholé/restful learning, memory work, recitation or chanting (language from the lexicon), contemplative elements; upper-level Socratic discussion and rhetoric are referenced in the classical rubric, but explicit evidence from the site is mixed (some elements of memory and review; some of the in-school focus on rigorous history/grammar). The site heavily features a blended model with structured in-person and remote learning. - Negative: The explicit emphasis on Socratic seminars, upper-school seminars, and formal rhetoric training is not clearly documented in core pages; the pedagogical methods described are not a full articulation of classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The blended pedagogy supports a classical-influenced approach but lacks consistent, explicit articulation of core classical teaching methods (Socratic seminars in upper grades, fully explicit

memory- and recitation-based pedagogy, dedicated rhetoric training). This places Pedagogy in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site highlights a named Head of School (Tracy Molina) and several faculty bios, indicating active teacher leadership and classroom roles. - The public materials frame teachers as professionals in leadership roles within the school ("Head of School & Teacher," "Faculty, Staff and School Board" pages). This suggests teachers are central to the school's operations and culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive: living curriculum, model teachers and mentors concept is part of classical pedagogy (the Lexicon emphasizes teachers as exemplar figures and the living curriculum). The site shows actual teacher profiles and a leadership structure, which aligns with the Classical emphasis on virtuous, capable teachers as a core element of formation. - Negative: The explicit language of "living curriculum" or a formal teacher-portrait standard is not directly quoted on core pages, though the bios and leadership pages imply it.

Why this rating - The presence of named faculty and leadership signals a strong instructional core, but the absence of explicit, codified descriptions of teachers as "the living curriculum" or a formal teacher-profile framework within core materials yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Parent partnership is central to the school's model, with explicit emphasis on partnership between parents and teachers, homeschooling integration, and a community of faith-based families. The "What Does Parent Partnership Mean?" article articulates a structured, faith-based, accountable community with high academic expectations and a focus on the whole child. - The site invites open participation, emphasizes family involvement, and describes a collaborative environment with ongoing communication and support for families, including blog content on partnership and a visible emphasis on parental co-teaching via the hybrid model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive: partnership, co-teachers, parental formation, book club-s/readings, family involvement, faith-based community. These map to the lexicon's Parents & Community indicators (partnership with parents, parental formation, open campus, etc.). The parent-partnership content demonstrates clear alignment with the classical vision of parents as co-educators and community participants. - Negative: No prominent signals of minimal parental involvement or consumer-like relationships; rather, the materials depict active parental engagement and governance.

Why this rating - The school's emphasis on parent partnership, family faith integration, and open parent involvement strongly aligns with CLASSICAL signals for Parents & Community. This is reinforced by explicit language about parents as co-teachers and a faith-based educational partnership.

Aggregate assessment and ranking - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Make Great Books and Great Conversation explicit in core Curriculum documentation: Add a formal statement that the curriculum includes Great Books and a Great Conversation component, with explicit references to primary sources and canonical authors, and specify how these integrate with history, literature, and philosophy across grades. (Evidence source: blog content and classical framing present, but explicit curriculum language is limited.)
- Expand explicit Socratic pedagogy for high school: Include a clear statement about Socratic seminars, debates, and student-led inquiries in upper grades, with examples of assessment aligned to rhetoric and logic training (as described in classical pedagogy).

- Codify the liberal-arts progression: Explicitly map the school's sequence of grammar, logic, and rhetoric across grade levels, including a plan for Latin or classical language study, to meet the Classical rubric's Curriculum expectations.
- Enrich liturgical and communal practices: Introduce regular liturgical or communal worship components, seasonal feasts, and structured liturgical life (beyond faith-based framing) to strengthen the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category.
- Deepen faculty as the living curriculum: Develop and publish a formal "Portrait of a Classical Teacher" and "Portrait of a Classical Student" to reflect the living-curriculum philosophy, as described in the Classical Lexicon.
- Expand parental formation offerings: Provide more structured parent-education resources (book studies, readings, seminars) linked to classical education philosophy to strengthen the Parents & Community category.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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